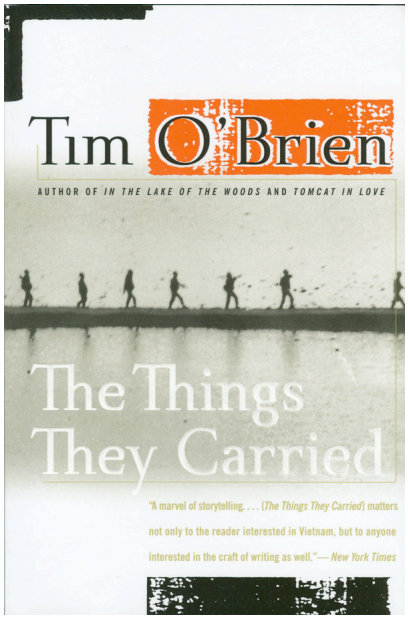
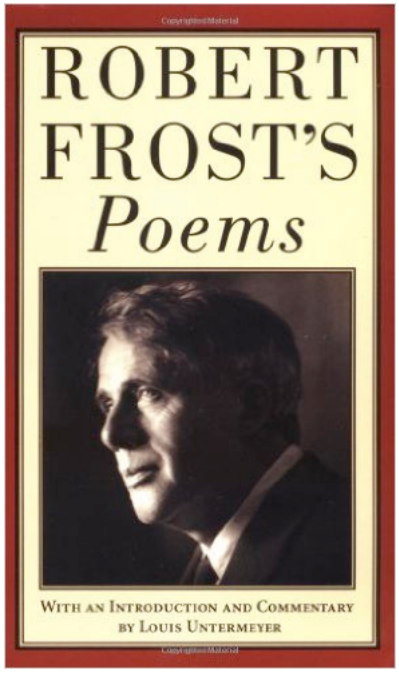
UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE

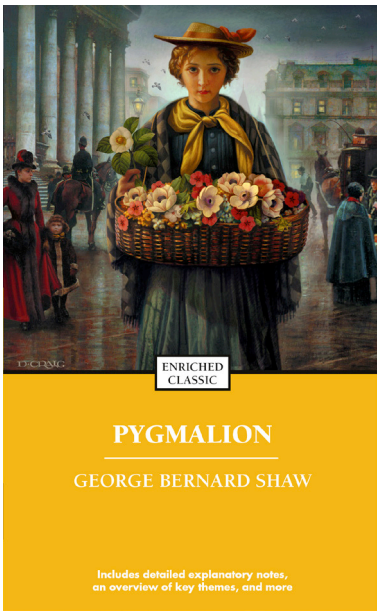
Making a World of Difference

Literary Criticism

Invitational A • 2016







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YOU ARE INSTRUCTED TO DO SO!

University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • Invitational B • 2016

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. A speech delivered while the speaker is alone and calculated to inform the audience of what is passing in the character's mind is known as a(n)
   A) apostrophe.
   B) aside.
   C) dramatic monologue.
   D) harangue.
   E) soliloquy.

2. The recipient of the 1932 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction for *The Good Earth* is
   A) Margaret Ayer Barnes.
   B) Pearl S. Buck.
   C) Harper Lee.
   D) Caroline Miller.
   E) Edith Wharton.

3. The emotional implications and associations that words may carry, as distinguished from the meanings usually offered as basic dictionary definitions, are known as a word's
   A) abridgment.
   B) connotation.
   C) definition.
   D) denotation.
   E) exposition.

4. The Muslim collection of scriptural writings–a collection of moral teaching, liturgical directions, and advice on religious conduct and ceremonials–recognized as an official transcription of revelations from the seventh century, is the
   A) Koran.
   B) *Märchen*.
   C) Mishnah.
   D) *Rubáiyát*.
   E) Septuagint.

5. The revival of emotional religion during the first half of the eighteenth century in America is known as
   A) Dandyism.
   B) the Great Awakening.
   C) the Harlem Renaissance.
   D) Philistinism.
   E) Transcendentalism.

6. The common English verse triple-syllable foot consisting of one accented syllable followed by two unaccented syllables is the
   A) anapest.
   B) antibacchius.
   C) dactyl.
   D) iamb.
   E) pyrrhic.

7. **Not** one of the novels written by the nineteenth-century American author Nathaniel Hawthorne is
   A) *The Blithedale Romance*.
   B) *The House of the Seven Gables*.
   C) *The Marble Faun*.
   D) *The Scarlet Letter*.
   E) *Uncle Tom's Cabin*.

8. The identity of terminal sound between primarily accented syllables, usually occupying corresponding positions in two or more lines of verse, is known as
   A) breve.
   B) diction.
   C) pitch.
   D) macron.
   E) rhyme.

9. A poem treating of shepherds and rustic life, the more sophisticated concept involving inversion, through which the complex is put into the simple, i.e. an expressing of complex ideas through simple personages, is known as a
   A) folk ballad.
   B) lipogram.
   C) pastoral.
   D) requiem.
   E) sapphic.

10. A list of printed (or manuscript) materials on any chosen topic is called a
    A) bibliography.
    B) chrestomathy.
    C) folio.
    D) footnote.
    E) lexicon.

11. The playwright who wrote *Fences* and *The Piano Lesson*, both of which earned him the Pulitzer Prize for Drama in 1987 and 1990, respectively, is

A) Neil Simon.
B) Alfred Uhry.
C) Thornton Wilder.
D) Tennessee Williams.
E) August Wilson.

12. **Not** one of the periods in the American canon during which writers and other artists were influenced by the great sectional and social problems that have been so much a part of the fabric of this nation is the

A) Federalist Age.
B) Naturalistic and Symbolistic Period.
C) Postmodern Period.
D) Realistic Period.
E) Romantic Period.

13. The term used by E. M. Forster for a character sufficiently complex to be able to surprise the reader without losing credibility is a

A) braggadocio.
B) flat character.
C) round character.
D) static character.
E) tritagonist.

14. The Irish author of *Mrs. Warren's Profession*, *Arms and the Man*, *Man and Superman*, and *Saint Joan* who received the 1925 Nobel Prize for Literature is

A) Samuel Beckett.
B) Mairéad Corrigan.
C) Seamus Heaney.
D) George Bernard Shaw.
E) William Butler Yeats.

15. The philosophical movement that reached America from Europe in the nineteenth century in which a reliance on intuition and the conscience characterizes artistic thought is

A) Existentialism.
B) Philistinism.
C) Pictorialism.
D) Transcendentalism.
E) Unitarianism.

16. The nineteenth-century American author of *Little Women, or Meg, Jo, Beth, and Amy*, *Little Men*, and *Jo's Boys and How They Turned Out* is

A) Louisa May Alcott.
B) Kate Chopin.
C) Emily Dickinson.
D) Margaret Fuller.
E) Harriet Beecher Stowe.

17. Something that is itself and which also stands for something else and that, in a literary sense, combines a literal and sensuous quality with an abstract or suggestive aspect is a(n)

A) emblem.
B) icon.
C) kitsch.
D) symbol.
E) volta.

18. **Not** one of the periods in English literary history that make up the English Renaissance Period, 1500-1660, is the

A) Caroline Age.
B) Commonwealth and Interregnum Period.
C) Elizabethan Age.
D) Jacobean Age.
E) Restoration Age.

19. A pantomime performance used in a play, particularly the silent acting as it appears in Elizabethan drama, is called

A) comic relief.
B) dramatis personae.
C) dumb show.
D) mock drama.
E) tableau.

20. The type of lyric poem that is characterized by its single, unified strain of exalted feeling and style, by its single purpose, and by its dealing with one theme is the

A) aubade.
B) ballad.
C) elegy.
D) hymn.
E) ode.

21. Writing marked by dialect, eccentric characters, and sentimentalized pathos or whimsical humor, and exploiting geographically specific speech, dress, mannerisms, and habits of thought, especially that writing associated with late nineteenth-century American artistic interest in the portrayal of a geographic setting is known as (a)

A) dialectic.
B) local color.
C) melodrama.
D) provincialism.
E) scenic method.

22. The immensely successful early twentieth-century British author of *The Moon and Sixpence*, *Of Human Bondag*e, *The Razor's Edge*, and *Cakes and Ale*, and *The Skeleton in the Cupboard* is

A) William Golding.
B) Rudyard Kipling.
C) W. Somerset Maugham.
D) Bertrand A. W. Russell.
E) George Bernard Shaw.

23. **Not** included as one of the stagings comprising the diagram that Gustav Freytag developed as a heuristic means of getting at the structure of a plot line is

A) catastrophe.
B) complication.
C) exposition.
D) reversal.
E) volta.

24. The twentieth-century British author of *To the Lighthouse* and leader of the Bloomsbury Group is

A) Agatha Christie.
B) Beatrix Potter.
C) Stevie Smith.
D) Virginia Woolf.
E) Charlotte M. Yonge.

25. The collective term derived from the *Edinburgh Review*'s contemptuous attitude regarding Wordsworth, Coleridge, and Robert Southey and their poetry is

A) Frankfort School.
B) Graveyard School.
C) Lake School.
D) Martian School.
E) Satanic School.

26. The name used by the nineteenth-century long-term British poet laureate Robert Southey to designate the members of the literary group made up of Lord Byron, Percy Bysshe Shelley, Leigh Hunt, and others, whose irregular lives and radical ideas, defiantly flaunted in their writings, suggested the name, is

A) Cockney School.
B) Frankfort School.
C) Geneva School.
D) Satanic School.
E) Spasmodic School.

27. The 2014 United States poet laureate from Tennessee who received the 1998 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry for his collection of lyrical meditations entitled *Black Zodiac* is

A) Richard Howard.
B) Philip Levine.
C) Paul Muldoon.
D) Mark Strand.
E) Charles Wright.

28. Literally meaning a "gathering of flowers," the term designating a collection of writings, usually by various authors, is

A) anthology.
B) chrestomathy.
C) compendium.
D) miscellany.
E) omnibus.

29. The device by which a work presents material that occurred prior to the opening scene of the work is

A) digression.
B) elaboration.
C) flashback.
D) foreshadowing.
E) prolepsis.

30. Literature—usually prose fiction—entirely or partly written as letters (not alphabetic characters) is known as (a)

A) documentary novel.
B) epistolary literature.
C) narratology.
D) transliteration.
E) vignette.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-36 are associated with George Bernard Shaw's *Pygmalion*.

Items 37-42 are associated with Tim O'Brien's *The Things They Carried*.

Items 43-50 are associated with Robert Frost's poetry (selected).

31. **Not** found among the characters in the first scene of Act I of George Bernard Shaw's *Pygmalion* is

A) The Bystander.
B) The Flower Girl.
C) The Hungarian Interpreter.
D) The Note Taker.
E) The Sarcastic Bystander.

32. The sharply delivered rebuke, "I want to change you from a [scullery maid] to a clean respectable girl to sit with the gentlemen in the study. Are you going to trust me and do what I tell you or be [. . .] sent back to your flower basket?" is delivered by

A) Colonel Pickering.
B) Mr. Doolittle.
C) Mr. Higgins.
D) Mrs. Higgins.
E) Mrs. Pearce.

33. According to his own mother, Higgins's behavior in church is not commendable, the example she offers being that her son "makes remarks out loud all the time" on the

A) clergyman's pronunciation.
B) gaudiness of the ladies' hats.
C) length of the sermons.
D) quality of the choir's singing.
E) requirement to tithe.

34. The reason that Higgins tells Eliza that, while she "may take the whole damned houseful" of belongings, she cannot take the jewels is that the jewels are

A) heirlooms.
B) hired.
C) pawned.
D) stolen.
E) uninsured.

35. Mr. Doolittle is "dressed something special" when he meets with Eliza after the experiment is over because

A) he fancies himself a resident of Wimpole Street.
B) he is going to marry Eliza's stepmother.
C) he is going to take out the garbage.
D) he received stock in a Pre-Digested Cheese Trust.
E) he spent the fiver on clothes instead of drink.

36. Eliza responds to Higgins's question regarding her father's line of work, saying that her father is a(n)

A) carpenter.
B) engineer.
C) florist.
D) navy.
E) undertaker.

37. The narrator of O'Brien's *The Things They Carried* observes that "for all the ambiguities of Vietnam, all the mysteries and unknowns, there was at least the single abiding certainty that they would never be at a loss for things" to

A) carry.
B) complain about.
C) kill.
D) run from.
E) worry about.

38. "I was brand-new to the war. It was my fourth day; I hadn't yet developed a sense of humor" constitutes O'Brien's recalling his first encounter with a(n)

A) dead body.
B) napalm drop.
C) open-field latrine.
D) story.
E) water buffalo.

39. Among the things that they carry is the talisman whose "magic doesn't go away," as one grunt declared; this talisman is the

A) pair of moccasins Kiowa takes along with him.
B) pair of pantyhose Dobbins wore around his neck.
C) pebble Martha gave Jimmy Cross.
D) set of comic books Rat Kiley packed.
E) slingshot Strunk had as a weapon of last resort.

40. The fishing resort at which O'Brien spends six days is the

A) Cozy Canadian Lodge.
B) Elroy Berdahl Lodge.
C) Rainy River Lodge.
D) Tip Top Lodge.
E) Whitefish Lake Lodge.

41. Song Tra Bong is the name of a(n)

A) landing zone in the Mekong Delta.
B) kind of booby-trap.
C) opera heard on night patrol in the jungle.
D) comic book character in Kiley's collection.
E) river associated with Mary Anne.

42. Two young boys walking with toy rifles, the war slang at the A&W, swimming in the dirty lake water, the fireworks, and the memory of a girl: even back home, the war echoes in the everyday for

A) Norman Bowker.
B) Jimmy Cross.
C) Henry Dobbins.
D) Bobby Jorgenson.
E) Mitchell Sanders.

Items 43-50 refer to Robert Frost's

The Oven Bird

There is a singer everyone has heard,
Loud, a mid-summer and a mid-wood bird,
Who makes the solid tree trunks sound again.
He says that leaves are old and that for flowers
Mid-summer is to spring as one to ten.
He says the early petal-fall is past
When pear and cherry bloom went down in showers
On sunny days a moment overcast;
And comes that other fall we name the fall.
He says the highway dust is over all.
The bird would cease and be as other birds
But that he knows in singing not to sing.
The question that he frames in all but words
Is what to make of a diminished thing.

43. The form of Robert Frost's "The Oven Bird" is the

A) fourteener.
B) pantoum.
C) *rime couée*.
D) sonnet.
E) *terza rima*.

44. The type of rhyme exhibited in the pairing of line 4 with line 7 is

A) feminine rhyme.
B) half rhyme.
C) leonine rhyme.
D) masculine rhyme.
E) mosaic rhyme.

45. The cross-pattern balance of line 11 constitutes (a)

A) asyndeton.
B) chiasmus.
C) pyramidal line.
D) rhopalic line.
E) zeugma.

46. The contradiction that characterizes line 12, "he knows in singing not to sing," is an example of

A) ambiguity.
B) hyperbole.
C) litotes.
D) paradox.
E) oxymoron.

47. The bird's song announces, through a tracing of the seasons from spring to fall (lines 5-9), that, among other things, the beauty of the woods is

A) ceasing.
B) diminishing.
C) flowering.
D) questioning.
E) showering.

48. The poem's dominant metric foot is the

A) anapestic foot.
B) dactylic foot.
C) iambic foot.
D) spondaic foot.
E) trochaic foot.

49. Line 3, "Who makes the solid tree trunks sound again," describes the

A) beauty of spring, ten to one.
B) echoing of the bird's song.
C) falling of the trees.
D) framing of the words.
E) questioning of the bird's meaning.

50. The intrusive element in the speaker's description of the bird's tracing of the seasonal differences in the woods is/are the

A) cherry blossoms.
B) clouds.
C) highway.
D) singing.
E) tree trunks.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-58 refer to Sylvia Plath's

Wreath for a Bridal

What though green leaves only witness
Such pact as is made once only; what matter
That owl voice sole "yes," while cows utter
Low moos of approve; let sun surpliced in brightness
Stand stock still to laud these mated ones
Whose stark act all coming double luck joins.

Couched daylong in cloisters of stinging nettle
They lie, cut-grass assaulting each separate sense
With savor; coupled so, pure paragons of constance,
This pair seek single state from that dual battle.
Now speak some sacrament to parry scruple
For wedlock wrought within love's proper chapel.

Call here with flying colors all watchful birds
To people the twigged aisles; lead babel tongues
Of animals to choir: "Look what thresh of wings
Wields guard of honor over these!" Starred with words
Let night bless that luck-rooted mead of clover
Where, bedded like angels, two burn one in fever.

From this holy day on, all pollen blown
Shall strew broadcast so rare a seed on wind
That every breath, thus teeming, set the land
Sprouting fruit, flowers, children most fair in legion
To slay spawn of dragon's teeth: speaking this promise,
Let flesh be knit, and each step hence go famous.

51. In Sylvia Plath's lyric poem "Wreath for a Bridal," the word *moos* (line 4) and the word *thresh* (line 15) are examples of

A) euphemism.
B) litotes.
C) merism.
D) onomatopoeia.
E) verisimilitude.

52. The repetition of sibilants **across** the final couplet, "To slay the spawn of dragon's teeth: speaking this promise, / Let flesh be knit, and each step go famous," is

A) cacophony.
B) euphony.
C) macaronic rhyme.
D) sigmatism.
E) zeugma.

53. Line 19, "From this holy day on, all pollen blown" is characterized by

A) alliteration.
B) assonance.
C) consonance.
D) dissonance.
E) resonance.

54. The imagery in line 18 depends on a

A) metaphor.
B) metonymy.
C) simile.
D) synecdoche.
E) tautology.

55. The melopoeic scheme that the poem's rhyme scheme depends on is

A) alliteration.
B) assonance.
C) consonance.
D) dissonance.
E) resonance.

56. The repetition of the initial *s*-sound in line 11 and the repetition of the initial *w*-sound in line 12, among other instances in the poem, are examples of

A) alliteration.
B) assonance.
C) consonance.
D) dissonance.
E) resonance.

57. The paired lines, lines 5 and 6, lines 8 and 9, line 13 and 14, lines 15 and 16, lines19 and 20, and lines 21 and 22 exhibit

A) compound rhyme.
B) feminine rhyme.
C) leonine rhyme.
D) masculine rhyme.
E) mosaic rhyme.

58. Line 4's "surplice in brightness," line 7's "cloisters," line 11's "sacrament," and line 15's "choir" contribute to the imagery of Plath's forest

A) chapel.
B) garden.
C) meadow.
D) orchard.
E) pasture.

Items 59-62 refer to William Empson's

Missing Dates

Slowly the poison the whole blood stream fills.
It is not the effort nor the failure tires.
The waste remains, the waste remains and kills.

It is not your system or clear sight that mills
Down small to the consequence a life requires;
Slowly the poison the whole blood stream fills.

They bled an old dog dry yet the exchange rills
Of young dog blood gave but a month's desires.
The waste remains, the waste remains and kills.

It is the Chinese tombs and the slag hills
Usurp the soil, and not the soil retires.
Slowly the poison the whole blood stream fills.

Not to have fire is to be a skin that shrills.
The complete fire is death. From partial fires
The waste remains, the waste remains and kills.

It is the poems you have lost, the ills
From missing dates, at which the heart expires.
Slowly the poison the whole blood stream fills.
The waste remains, the waste remains and kills.

59. The form of William Empson's poem "Missing Dates" is the

A) *chant royal*.
B) pantoum.
C) rondeau.
D) *terza rima*.
E) villanelle.

60. Each of the three-lined stanzas is a

A) tercet.
B) tribrach.
C) trilogy.
D) triolet.
E) triplet.

61. The repetition in close proximity of *bled* and *blood* (lines 7-8), two words that have the same root, is

A) anaphora.
B) epanalepsis.
C) interpolation.
D) polyptoton.
E) symploce.

62.. The imagery that dominates Empson's poem is

A) auditory imagery.
B) gustatory imagery.
C) olfactory imagery.
D) tactile imagery.
E) visual imagery.

Items 63-65 refer to William Wordsworth's

Composed upon Westminster Bridge, September 3, 1802

Earth has not anything to show more fair:
Dull would he be of soul who could pass by
A sight so touching in its majesty:
This City now doth, like a garment, wear
The beauty of the morning; silent, bare,
Ships, towers, domes, theatres, and temples lie
Open unto the fields, and to the sky;
All bright and glittering in the smokeless air.
Never did sun more beautifully steep
In his first splendour, valley, rock, or hill;
Ne'er saw I, never felt, a calm so deep!
The river glideth at his own sweet will:
Dear God! the very houses seem asleep;
And all that mighty heart is lying still!

63. William Wordsworth's poem "Composed upon Westminster Bridge" is a(n)

A) Anglo-Norman sonnet.
B) English sonnet.
C) Italian sonnet.
D) Miltonic sonnet.
E) Spenserian sonnet.

64. The sonnet's volta is found at the beginning of

A) line 4.
B) line 9.
C) line 10.
D) line 11.
E) line 13.

65. The accommodation of rhythm and rhyme characterizing the word order of lines 9-10, constitutes

A) abridgment.
B) deconstruction.
C) enjambment.
D) hypotaxis.
E) inversion.

The required Tie-Breaking Essay prompt is found on the next page.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie. Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Robert Frost's "A Leaf Treader," and offer a discussion of what the speaker in the poem infers that he (we) might learn from nature, especially by regarding the life cycle of a leaf.

A Leaf Treader

I have been treading on leaves all day until I am autumn-tired.
God knows all the color and forms of leaves I have trodden on and mired.
Perhaps I have put forth too much strength and been too fierce from fear.
I have safely trodden under foot the leaves of another year.

All summer long they were overhead more lifted up than I;
To come to their final place in earth they had to pass me by.
All summer long I thought I heard them threatening under their breath,
And when they came it seemed with a will to carry me with them to death.

They spoke to the fugitive in my heart as if it were leaves to leaf;
They tapped at my eyelids and touched my lips with an invitation to grief.
But it was no reason I had to go because they had to go.
Now up, my knee, to keep on top of another year of snow.

ANSWER SHEET

UIL Literary Criticism
Invitational B • 2016

Items 1-30 **1** *point each*

1. ____
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28. ____
29. ____
30. ____

Items 31-65 **2** *points each*

31. ____
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Part 3

_____
contestant number

_____
SCORE

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

FIRST GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

\+

number correct x 2 _____

= _____

_____
initials

SECOND GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

\+

number correct x 2 _____

= _____

_____
initials

THIRD GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

\+

number correct x 2 _____

= _____

_____
initials

KEY

UIL Literary Criticism Invitational B • 2016

line arrows up ➔

1.	E	449
2.	B	602
3.	B	107
4.	A	267
5.	B	47
6.	C	129
7.	E	561
8.	E	413
9.	C	354
10.	A	55
11.	E	608
12.	A	195
13.	C	425
14.	D	599
15.	D	483
16.	A	564
17.	D	467
18.	E	173
19.	C	159
20.	E	334
21.	B	277
22.	C	573
23.	E	498
24.	D	61
25.	C	268
26.	D	427
27.	E	605
28.	A	30
29.	C	200
30.	B	179
31.	C	87
32.	E	46
33.	A	132
34.	B	101
35.	B	121
36.	D	62
37.	A	15
38.	A	214
39.	B	111
40.	D	45
41.	E	85
42.	A	141-48
43.	D	449
44.	A	196
45.	B	84
46.	D	349
47.	B	
48.	C	244
49.	B	
50.	C	
51.	D	337
52.	D	
53.	B	43
54.	C	445
55.	C	107
56.	A	13
57.	D	287
58.	A	
59.	E	497
60.	A	474
61.	D	372
62.	E	
63.	C	260
64.	B	
65.	E	257

FOLD along the **three** longitudinal lines for ease in grading. ➔

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

DO NOT mark (cross out) actual **LETTER** answer; mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer to the *Handbook* 12e, the Simon & Schuster *Pygmalion*, the Mariner-Houghton *The Things They Carried*, and to Untermeyer's Frost collection.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Robert Frost's "A Leaf Treader"

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used in a discussion of what the speaker in the poem infers he (we) might learn from nature, especially through a comparison involving the life cycle of a leaf include

alliteration,
anaphora,
apostrophe,
characterization,
consonance,
controlling image,
couplet,
end-stopped line,
iamb/iambic,
imagery,
metaphor,
polyptoton,
rhyme scheme,
rhythm,
simile,
synecdoche,
theme, and
tone.

The speaker in Frost's poem points, in line 9, to a similarity between the falling/fallen leaves and the "fugitive in [his] heart," perhaps running from the fact that is death. The young contestant should be able to identify autumn as the poem's controlling image or as a metaphor—as well as the recurring/returning source of threat (line 7) and grief (line 10).

The contestant should recognize that the speaker likens the life cycle of the leaf to his own life. In the final stanza, however, he breaks the comparison, noting that he does not have to accept the "invitation to grief" (line 10): "it was no reason I had to because [the leaves] had to go [to their deaths]." Indeed, the last line of the poem records the speaker's reminding himself (his knee) that the last stages of the leaves' life cycle, while having made him "autumn-tired" (line 1), are not his, at least not this year.

The writer might sense a tone of triumph in that the "fugitive in [his] heart" refuses the "invitation to grief" and that he survives; indeed, his triumphal walk, "safely trodd[ing] under foot the leaves of another year" (line 4), is the walk of a leaf treader.

The student might venture the observation that even the act of considering death, especially in a manner that suggests a recurring victory reflected in the self-absorbed musing, "God knows all the color and forms of leaves I have trodden on and mired," reveals a deep concern about death, a concern inferred in the self-reflective line, "Perhaps I have put forth too much strength and have been fierce from fear" (line 3).

The writer might make something of all of the end-topped lines' contributing to either or both the poem's theme and tone.